



St Pats Donabate



Football Workshop
Coaching the Core Skills



Ages U8 – U12

THE GOLDEN AGE FOR SKILL DEVELOPMENT



Windows of opportunity

Age in
years:

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

11

12

Optimum for fundamentals

Remedial

Speed

Golden age for learning skills

Suppleness

By the age of 12, the **range of motion** and the **style of motion** is more or less set for life

PRIMARY & SECONDARY SKILLS



PRIMARY SKILLS

KICKING, SOLOING, HANDPASSING & CATCHING

SECONDARY SKILLS

BOUNCING, PICK-UP & MOVING



KICKING

COACHING Q'S

HANDS DOWN - HEAD DOWN – STEP – DROP - KICK.

BALL TO THE FOOT NOT FOOT TO BALL

PROGRESSIONS

HEAD DOWN - EYE ON THE BALL - FOLLOW THROUGH

RIGHT HAND TO RIGHT FOOT

LEFT HAND TO LEFT FOOT

TRIGGER WORDS

ROLL IT OFF THE BOTTOM SHELF

ELEPHANT STOMP

PUNCH IT WITH YOUR LACES

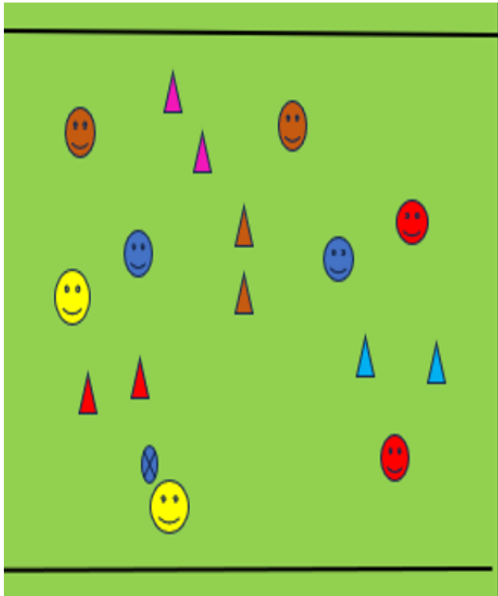


Kicking

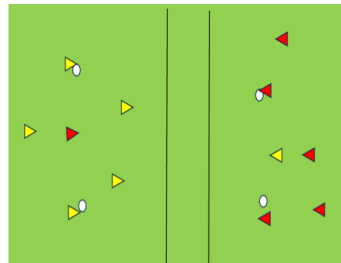


Game 2 - Through the gates

Set -up 4 - 6 pairs of cones in a playing area.
Players have to kick the ball through the gates to their partner progress to the next set of goals.
First to complete all 4 sets of goals wins.



Across the River Tennis Game



Mark out a tennis court style pitch with 2 sets of cones in the middle about 5 yards apart.
Divide into 2 teams with 5 or 6 players on each side.
1 player from each team goes to the far side of the court

Scoring –
1 point for a kick that lands in the opposite half without been caught.
1 point for a catch.
2 points for a ball caught by the teams player on the far side of the court.
First team to 15 wins.

Key Coachings

Kicking – Hands Down Head Down Step-drop-kick
Right hand to right foot left hand to left foot
Overhead Catching
Hands in a W shape with fingers spread wide
Eyes on the ball

5 v 5 Kick Passing Possession Game

Teams have to retain possession but points are only scored by completing a kickpass of more than 10 metres.

Scoring

1 Point for a kickpass.
2 Points for a kickpass with the non-dominant foot.

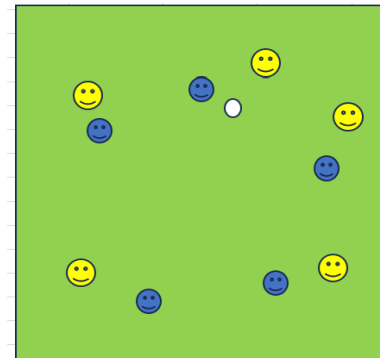
Space - 35m x 40m

Time – 15-30 Mins

Equipment- Large Cones & 4 Balls

People – 8-10 Players & 2 Coaches

Rules – Make pitch larger if too small limit to one touch on the ball if kids are carrying too much

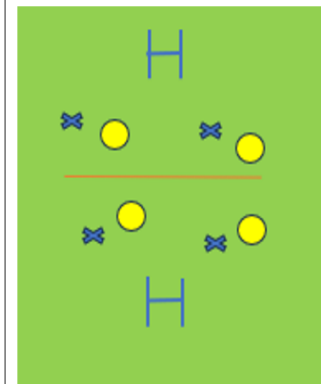


Coaching Objectives

Technical

Hands down head down step drop kick follow through.
Two Hands one hand kick
Right hand to right foot
Left Hand to left foot
One bounce no more

4 v 4 - Skills match Focus on kickpassing & Game play Concepts



(2 points for a completed kick pass 1 point for a score)
Divide Teams evenly into 4 v 4 or 5 v 5
Players that passes the ball and their marker can only cross the half way line and encourage Ball can only kickpass over the half way lin.

Scoring

2 points for a completed kick pass
1 point for a score.

First to 8 wins. Change backs and forwards for the each match.



SOLOING

COACHING Q'S

HANDS DOWN - HEAD DOWN – STEP – DROP - FLICK.

BALL TO THE FOOT NOT FOOT TO BALL

PROGRESSIONS

SOLOING OUT OF ONE HAND

RIGHT HAND TO RIGHT FOOT

LEFT HAND TO LEFT FOOT

TRIGGER WORDS

ROLL IT OFF THE BOTTOM SHELF

ELEPHANT STOMP

TOES TO THE NOSE



SOLOING



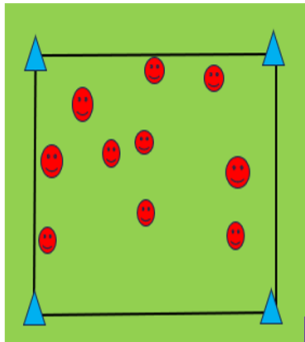
Solo Game 1 - Bumper solos last person standing

Space – in a square approximately 15 metres x 15

Time – Til last player exits

Equipment – Ball / Player & Cones

People - 8 - 10 Players & 1/2 Mentors.



Players run/walk around square taking 4 steps then soloing the ball avoiding traffic.

Player exits game once they drop the ball. They continue running around the outside of the square until the game ends.

Progression 1 Players use non dominant foot.

Progression 2 add a coach as a token defender.

Coaching Objectives

Technique – 4 steps Hands Down/Head down/Step/drop/Flick

Right hand to right foot Left hand to left foot

Tactical - Head up and scan.

Solo Game 2 Gates Game



In a tight environment players must identify space and learn to exploit it.

A large square is set up (25m x 25m) with a variety of small goals randomly placed around the inside (see diagram).

Progression 1 - Solos with dominant and non-dominant feet and can bounce with non dominant hand.

Progression 2 - Solos on non-dominant foot only.

Progression 3 - Partner shadows player as they solo the ball player solos the ball on the side away from the defender.

Coaching Objectives

Technique – 4 steps Hands Down/Head down/Step/drop/Flick

Right hand to right foot Left hand to left foot

Head up and scan.

Tactical - Head up and scan.

WARM UP – SOLO TAG



Runners (RED) maintain the ball while evading taggers (BLUE) for a set period of time.

All players must play ball every 4 steps. If tagged, you are out.

** A tag is when the chaser presses the ball against a runner. When a player is tagged, he freezes and completes 5 solos before returning to the game.

Participant Feedback

How will you know where the other players are in the grid?

Head up, scan to see the taggers

What should you do to protect your ball?

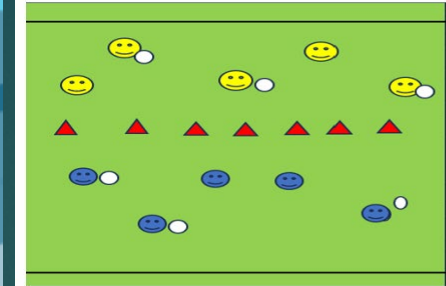
Carry ball in 2 hands between plays

Take 4 steps between plays

When performing the toe tap with the right foot, what hand should you drop the ball with?

Right hand

The Solo Bulldog



5 or 6 players on each side of a line of cones with 3 balls for each team.

Player must try to work ball to the far endzone without been tagged to get a score. Players in their own half can pass the ball to each other.

Players can only enter opposition half in possession of the ball.

Any player with or without a ball can tag a player that enters their half.

Once tagged a player must go back to their half with the ball and start again.

If player solos with non-dominant foot they get 2 scores first team to 8 wins.

Key Coaching Solo Technique

Hands down head down step-drop-flick.

Right hand to right foot

Left hand to left foot



HANDPASSING

COACHING Q'S

THE WAITER AND THE BOWLER

HOLD THE BALL LIKE A WAITER

STEP FORWARD AND STRIKE LIKE A BOWLER

HANDS DOWN - HEAD DOWN - 2HANDS 1 HAND- STRAIGHT BACK AND STRAIGHT OUT - FOLLOW THROUGH TOWARDS THE TARGET

TRIGGERS

THE WAITER, THE BOWLER & SPIDERMAN

HOLD THE BALL LIKE A WAITER

STEP FORWARD AND STRIKE LIKE A BOWLER

FOLLOW THROUGH WITH YOUR HAND LIKE SPIDERMAN



HANDPASSING



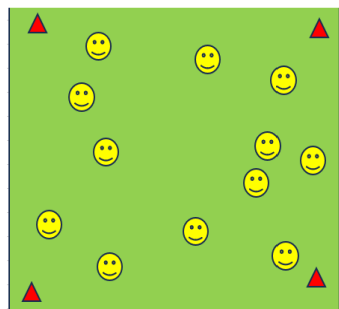
The Waiter & the Bowler Handpassing

The Waiter

Hold ball in one hand at waist height while running around square avoiding the other players.

Progression 1 Move the ball to non dominant hand. other players have to try knock ball loose.

Progression 2 Players can knock ball out of players hand with their near hand.



The Bowler

Practise throwing the ball between two players like a Bowler throwing hand should end up facing the target not facing the sky. (Think Spiderman)

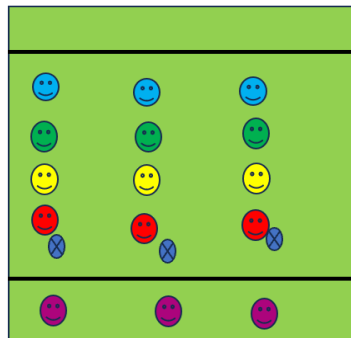
Progression 1 In 3's Throw underarm through hoola hoops. 1 player holds hoola hoop at head height in the middle of other two players.

Progression 2 handpass the ball through the hoola hoops. (Bring the holding the ball (the waiter) and the throwing the ball (the bowler) together)

Critical Elements of Underhand Throwing



Hand Pass Relay



Each team has 5 cones left at the starting point.
Player 1 Red Starts with the ball handpasses it to Purple
Purple handpasses it back.

Red does to the end of the line behind blue then Yellow handpasses to Purple and so on until every player has handpassed the ball to Purple.

Once Completed yellow takes a small cone and places it on a large cone and replaces purple.

Once a team has completed all 5 rounds and has all 5 small cones at the starting point that teams wins

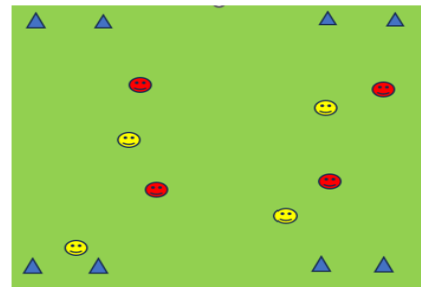
Coaching Objectives

Handpassing Technique

Hands – Holding Hand down (the Waiter)
Striking hand straight back and out towards the target (The Bowler).
Head – Down looking at the ball.
Feet – Left foot forward when striking with right hand (The Bowler)

Spot & Fix to correct

Game 4 - The 4 Goal 4 v 4 Game



Space – 25 m x 30 m

Time – Play 2 a score ie first to 5 or for 3 minutes

Equipment – 3 balls & Cones to mark out pitch area

Players - 4 v 4 max 5 v 5 & 2 mentors

Team 1 start with the ball and they attack either of the goals at the far end of the pitch.

Ball can only be moved by hand passing the ball and player on the ball is only allowed one touch either a bounce or a solo.

Ball can be handpassed through either of the goals for a score.

First to 5 wins.

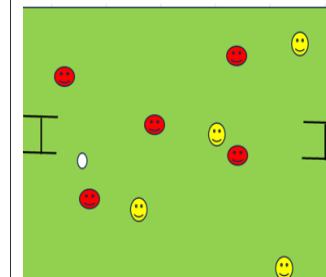
Progression - move to no solos or bounces allowed

Key coaching Points –

Technique & 4 Steps

Tactical - Focus on Head up/ Find the space / move the ball away from traffic/ and follow ur pass.

Olympic Handpass



Space - 35 m x 25m

Time - 15m

Equipment - 2 Goals, Cones and 3 balls

People – 4 v 4 or 5 v 5, 2 coaches

Teams must progress the ball without bouncing or soloing the ball only 4 steps allowed.

Points can be scored by either crossing an endline or by scoring into goals.

An extra point can be awarded for points scored with non dominant hand

Key Coaching Points –

What we do when we have the ball?

Head up before and as soon as we receive the ball, follow ur pass and support the ball.

Handpassing Technique

Hands holding hand down (the waiter), striking hand straight back follow through towards the target (Spiderman).

Head down eye on the ball

Feet step forward like a bowler (opposite foot to striking hand)



OVERHEAD CATCH

COACHING Q'S

HANDS – INFRONT AND ABOVE THE HEAD, FINGERS SPREAD WIDE AND HANDS IN A “W”

HEAD – HEAD UP EYE ON THE BALL

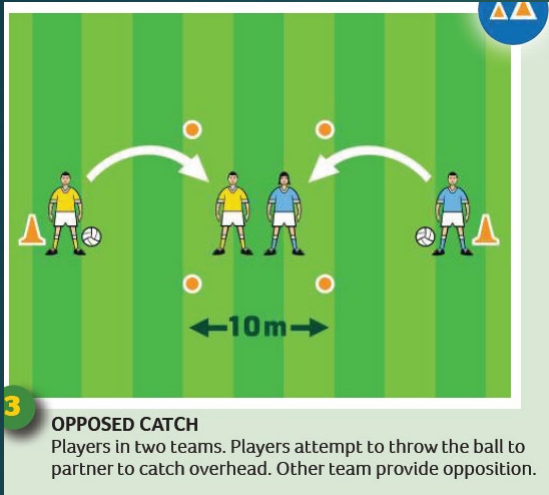
FEET – PLANT THE JUMPING FOOT AND SWING THE OPPOSITE KNEE UPWARD FOR MAXIMUM HEIGHT AND PROTECTION (THINK SKIPPING MOTION).

TRIGGERS

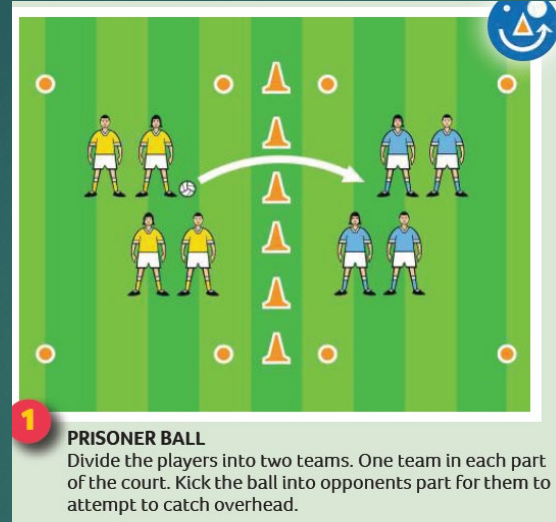
CATCH IT AND WRAP IT!



OVERHEAD CATCH



1 minute on
1 minute off



2 players compete
for the ball
2 players compete
for the breaking ball.

Olympic Handpass Catching Game

Teams must progress the ball by throwing the ball to a teammate. The pass must be over the teammates head and cannot be contested by the opposition. The player in possession of the ball can only take 4 steps with the ball and then must pass.

Points can be scored by either crossing an endl ine or by scoring into goals.

Progression 1
Use Bounce Pass.

Key Coaching Points – Technique –

Hands- Fingers spread wide and hands in a “W” shape.

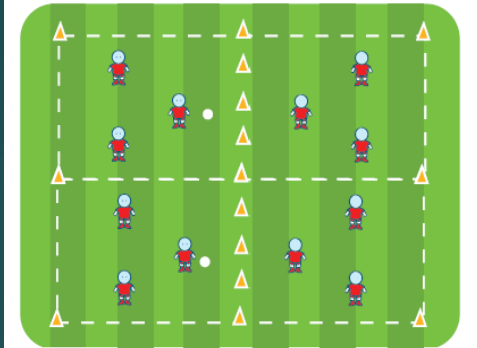
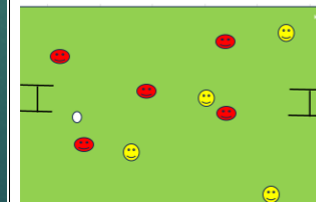
Head – Head up eye on the ball.

Feet- Plant the jumping foot and swing the opposite knee upward for maximum height and protection (Think skipping motion).

Tactical

What we do when we have the ball?

Head up before and as soon as we receive the ball, find the space to receive the pass, follow up pass and support the ball.



This is a fun game that rewards players for performing a high catch. (Set up as many grids as possible to avoid large teams).

A grid is set up 20 x 10m with a line of cones across the middle.

Players are divided into two teams (max 3 or 4).

The team who starts with the ball must kick it high into the air with the aim of trying to land it in the opposition zone.

If it lands on the ground in the opposition zone whoever is closest to it must go to jail and perform 10 high catches with the coach before they can join their team again.

If the ball is caught with a high catch that team gets a point.

If the ball lands outside the zone the kicker must go to jail.

Variation:

If players are struggling to keep kicks inside the zone you can allow them to throw the ball into the air.

Progression :

A second ball can be added to make players have to think and work more.

The area can be made larger so players have to cover more space in order to perform the catch.